

Graphic Design Master Class

With Daniel Mgawi using Figma

Course Overview

This intensive master class is designed to take students from fundamental design concepts to professional-grade execution. With a focus on practical, hands-on learning, students will develop a comprehensive skill set applicable to real-world design challenges.

Module 1: Design Fundamentals (4 Weeks)

Week 1: Introduction to Design Principles

- Elements of design: line, shape, color, texture, space
- Principles of design: balance, contrast, emphasis, rhythm, unity
- Visual perception and Gestalt principles
- Design history and contemporary trends
- **Practical Exercise:** Visual analysis of effective designs
- **Resources:**
 - [What is UI Design?](#)
 - [What is UI and UX?](#)

Week 2: Mastering the Pen Tool

- Introduction to vector graphics
- Pen tool anatomy and functionality in Figma
- Anchor points, handles, and paths
- Practice exercises using [Bezier Game](#)
- Advanced pen tool techniques: corners, curves, and precision drawing
- **Practical Exercise:** Create complex shapes and illustrations using only the pen tool
- **Resources:**
 - [Bezier Game - Pen Tool Practice](#)
 - [The Pen Tool: Mastering the Basic](#)

Week 3: Color Theory and Psychology

- Color models (RGB, CMYK, HSB)
- Color psychology and emotional responses
- Creating effective color schemes
- Color harmony and contrast
- Accessibility considerations in color choices
- **Practical Exercise:** Develop multiple color palettes for different brand personalities
- **Tools:**
 - [Coolors](#)
 - [Adobe Color](#)
 - [Color Contrast Checker](#)
- **Resources:**
 - [Color Theory](#)

Week 4: Typography Fundamentals

- Typeface anatomy and classification
- Font pairing principles
- Hierarchy and readability
- Typesetting best practices
- Responsive typography
- **Practical Exercise:** Create a typographic poster with effective hierarchy
- **Tools:**
 - [Type Scale](#)
 - [Google Fonts Knowledge](#)
- **Resources:**
 - [Typography Basics](#)
 - [Practical Typography](#)

Module 2: Visual Communication (4 Weeks)

Week 5: Layout Theory and Composition

- Grid systems and structure
- White space and visual breathing room
- F-pattern and Z-pattern in layout design
- Responsive design principles
- Golden ratio and other composition frameworks
- **Practical Exercise:** Create multiple layouts for print and digital platforms

- **Resources:**
 - [Layout Design Basics](#)
 - [Golden Ratio in Design](#)

Week 6: Brand Identity Development

- Brand strategy fundamentals
 - Logo design principles and the 7 types of logos:
 - Lettermarks (Monograms)
 - Wordmarks (Logotypes)
 - Pictorial marks
 - Abstract logo marks
 - Mascots
 - Combination marks
 - Emblems
 - Visual identity systems
 - Brand style guides
 - Consistent brand application
 - **Practical Exercise:** Create a comprehensive brand identity for a fictional company
 - **Resources:**
 - [Logo Design Love](#)
 - [Brand New](#)
 - [Visual Hierarchy](#)
 - [Design Better](#)
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Module 3: Professional Practice (4 Weeks)

Week 9: Project Workflow Management

- Design process and project phases
- Time management for designers
- Client brief development
- Feedback integration methods
- Version control and file organization
- **Practical Exercise:** Develop a project plan and timeline for a comprehensive design project

Week 10: Client Communication

- Presentation techniques
- Explaining design decisions
- Handling revisions and feedback
- Pricing strategies and proposals
- Contract essentials for designers
- **Resources:**
 - [Behance](#)
 - [Dribbble](#)
 - [Case Study Club](#)

Week 11: Design Ethics and Industry Standards

- Copyright and fair use
 - Accessibility standards (WCAG)
 - Sustainable design practices
 - Design ethics and inclusivity
 - Staying current in the industry
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Additional Resources

Design Software Tutorials

- [Figma Learning Resources](#)
- [Figma Crash Course](#)

Pen Tool Practice

- [Bezier Game](#)
- [Illustrator Pen Tool Exercises](#)

Typography Resources

- [Practical Typography](#)
- [Google Fonts Knowledge](#)
- [Type Scale](#)

Color Tools

- [Coolors](#)
- [Adobe Color](#)

- [Color Contrast Checker](#)

Design Inspiration

- [Behance](#)
 - [Dribbble](#)
 - [Awwwards](#)
 - [Muzli Design Inspiration](#)
 - [Lapa Ninja](#)
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Course Schedule

- **Duration:** 11 weeks
- **Sessions:** Tuesdays and Thursdays, 6:00 PM - 8:00 PM
- **Platform:** Zoom
- **Registration:** Scan the QR code or visit <https://bit.ly/4cxw7A1>
- **Contact:** info@techitupproject.com | +265 997 82 48 74 | +265 888 558 588